



These photos were taken using the camera of a K750i. Note that none of these show the road completely empty

Magic!

In Photoshop CS3 Extended, you can add to auto-align with Smart Object Stacks. You won't find this in the public beta—that's the Standard version—so read on.

The eight photos you see here were taken from a balcony—we wanted to get an empty road sans cars or people, but we couldn't get a single such shot. The time of day didn't matter—you'll rarely find the street in question empty in the daytime. So unless we cordoned off the area, we weren't going to get our shot—and we don't have that kind of clout.

The photos were then loaded into Photoshop CS3 using the very handy "Load Files Into Stack" script from the Scripts menu (also not in the public beta)—this just loads each photo into a new layer rather than a new file. We first aligned the photos using Auto-align, and then converted the lot into a smart object (Layer > Smart Objects > Convert To Smart Object). We're probably going to sound like excited children here, but this last bit never ceases to amaze us. Under Layer > Smart Objects is Stack Mode—selecting Median under this menu retains the pixels that



haven't moved—which means that all the people and cars are eliminated! All this, and the only effort you expend is a few clicks here and there.

that need texturing for, say, a document for print, this makes it much easier.

In Other News...

CS3 also brings us a bunch of small tweaks that make life that much easier. The Curves dialog, for instance, is a bit more newbie-friendly. New Adjustment Layers are here, too—you can now apply Curves, Brightness & Contrast and Channel Mixer Adjustment Layers. The Brightness & Contrast adjustment now operates on colour brightness rather than absolute image brightness, which makes for some very interesting results. You can also extract images from PDF files and edit them.

Graphics Everywhere

Now that you'll be viewing content on a variety of media, from your cell phone to handheld to

who knows what, all CS3 products are tied together with Adobe Device Central. Whether you're creating images in Photoshop, animations and games in Flash or Web pages in Dreamweaver, you'll always have the option to preview the mobile version of your creation using Device Central.

With the CS3 Suite, you can work on your files almost seamlessly between programs. Vector graphics will move swiftly and without losses between Illustrator and Flash, images will shuttle between Photoshop and InDesign in a snap, and site designs will go from Fireworks to Dreamweaver like *that*.

We'll get you more dirt on the lot when we get our hands on the final release—it's going to knock your socks off; that we know. ■

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